

flood guns keep the path of the beam continuously illuminated. This allows the video display itself to act as memory storage for the computer. The detail and resolution of the image can be very high, and the vector computer slowly paints out paragraphs of text and complex images in a few minutes, while the storage display kept the previously written parts continuously visible. The image retention of a storage display can last for several hours with the vector storage display powered, but the screen can be cleared instantly with the push of a button or a signal from the driving vector computer.

Vectorising is good for removing unnecessary detail from a photograph. This is useful for information graphics or line art (images were converted to JPEG for display on this page). Detail can be added or removed from vector art and vector illustrations can have their own colours, allowing artists to achieve desired results.

Modern vector graphic displays can sometimes be found at laser light shows, using two fast-moving X-Y mirrors to rapidly draw shapes and text on a large screen. The term vector graphics is mainly used today in the context of two-dimensional computer graphics. It is one of several modes an artist can use, to create an image on a raster display. Other modes include text, multimedia and 3D-rendering. Virtually all modern 3D-rendering is done using extensions of 2D vector graphics techniques. Plotters used in technical drawings still draw vectors directly on paper.

For example, consider a circle with radius r . The main elements of information a program needs in order to draw this circle are as follows.

- The following data describe a circle
- The radius r and equation of the circle
- The location of the centre of the circle
- Stroke line style and colour (possibly transparent)
- Fill style and colour (possibly transparent)
- Advantages to this style of drawing over raster graphics:

This minimal amount of information translates to a much smaller file size compared to large raster images (the size of rep-